

Important notes:

- ▶ There is no fixed method to unlock your Windows Phone device, and methods vary from device to device, given the myriad of different Windows Phone devices currently available. We won't cover all the unlocking methods individually, but will cover only the most popular techniques that should work on most, but not all Windows Phone devices.
- ▶ Read all the instructions carefully and only proceed when you have thoroughly understood them.
- ▶ Check your phone's OS version, in fact, double-check it. Trying to unlock the wrong version can result in your device getting bricked.
- ▶ When downloading a custom ROM, ensure that the ROM supports your phone, otherwise your device can be bricked.
- ▶ Make sure that all the required software has been downloaded beforehand and have been installed as specified.
- ▶ If you have frequent power-cuts in your area, make sure you have a UPS, or are unlocking your device using a laptop, or are doing this at a time when you know you have uninterrupted power.
- ▶ Make sure your phone's battery is fully charged.
- ▶ Take a complete backup of all the data on the phone as some of these hacks involve a complete format of the phone's memory.
- ▶ Most importantly, ensure that you are wide awake and in your senses.

What you need

Here is a list of prerequisite software that you need to have installed.

- ▶ Microsoft Zune desktop software (<http://dgit.in/MLxQPj>)
- ▶ Windows Phone SDK (<http://dgit.in/NP2IUn>)
- ▶ Chevron WP7 hack and certificate (on the Omega DVD)
- ▶ A custom ROM of your choice. (if you want to indulge in some modding action)

In general, there are two methods of unlocking your device. The first method is the “interop” unlock, which will allow you to side-load apps without the penalty of having to mess with your ROM and risking a bricked device. The second method is a true jailbreak, but only meant for those who are brave of heart and don't mind risking their devices.

The actual process of jailbreaking is nearly identical for all devices. We will provide step-by-step instructions for Jailbreaking a Samsung Focus v1.3 device here, which is applicable to almost all jailbreak ready Samsung devices. The jailbreaking of HTC devices is much more complicated though.